

DIGITALISATION: An Imperative For New-Age India



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Every once in a while, a new technology or innovative practice takes the world by storm, but soon the technology or practice becomes more of a fad than a way of life. It changes the pace and scope and disrupts for a while, after which another trend takes over. Digitalisation stands out because it has shown that it can be a real equaliser, a fast track to growth and development, and could solve problems hitherto not touched yet for want of even a semblance of an available solution.

For a country like India, which has 70 years of freedom behind it, digitalisation could be a real game-changer. Its extensive reach, seamless connectivity and mass digital literacy are aspects that can truly ring in the dawn of a digitalised India. With the Internet of Things (IoT) revolution and upward graph of economic growth, a truly digital India in the next five years is not an unreachable goal. The seed of a massive revolution that digitalisation holds within it has potentially opened up unlimited opportunities for businesses—to pioneer this transformation, to achieve increased profitability in the process and to enable businesses achieve customer delight.

A few critical aspects that all businesses, startups or proven industry leaders need to lay emphasis on in order to attain their digital best and help the nation's goal post of a digital India are discussed in this article.

With transparency we will see value

The modern consumer, who has embraced e-Commerce, needs, expects and demands transparency. We have always

had an uncaring attitude about the lack of transparency prevailing in most government services. However, the government has begun to take key steps to digitise its services for the public, because it sees the value in these services. Digitalisation can help in the transmission of government subsidies and benefits to the last mile, thereby reaching the remotest areas, and truly democratise. This opens up the possibilities of digitising all public services offered to the common man. The difference it would make to governance could be overwhelming.

While information and process clarity is visible across the Web and portals, these can be extended to mobile devices as well. Businesses are changing their strategies to get their services out through mobiles and to a heavily mobile-using audience. Also, digital channels and social media are leveraged to promote the existence of such government services and enhance its usage. Digital India is one such initiative that has gained traction through it.

The freshness of innovation

Everyday niche products and services are thought of and brought to the market, thanks to innovation, without which sustainability of businesses hangs by a thread. Benefits of efficiency in production and operations has given innovation that status. A simple thing like connecting rural and agrarian communities with the Internet is making a vast difference in the quality of lives of the people there. Mobile money and digital healthcare services are a few areas that are making inroads to help marginalised communities.

Innovation results in solutions that would transform the way businesses and government bodies communicate with the customer/stakeholder contextually and ubiquitously. This almost magical quality

The nine pillars of Digital India (Image courtesy: www.bharatniti.in)

